

Greater Columbus Music Census Partner Preview

Agenda

- Why a Census & Why Now
- Census Process Review
- 10 Key Indicator Areas
- Indicators & Insights
- Opportunities
- What do WE do Now?

Why a Census and Why Now?

- To provide a more detailed understanding of our music community - behavioral trends, demographics, etc.
- To bring to light different subgroups and their perspectives
- To help identify needs and fill gaps in current programming
- Data unique to Columbus' opportunities and constraints BUT also,
- Data directly comparable to other participating cities

Census Process

- Responses collected: November 6th - December 15th
- Methodology - anonymous, digital, open to all 18+ years old who live in the greater Columbus area and contribute to our music community
- Central Ohio Counties represented: Delaware, Fairfield, Franklin, Hocking, Licking, Madison, Morrow, Perry, Pickaway, and Union

10 Key Indicator Areas

1. Ecosystem Composition
2. Creative Profile
3. Venue Profile
4. Industry Profile
5. Economic Activity
6. Ecosystem Development
7. Workforce Development
8. Livability
9. Music Friendly Policies
10. Culture & Belonging

Ecosystem Composition

70% Male; 26% Female; 1% Transgender; 3% Unspecified

1,555 responses

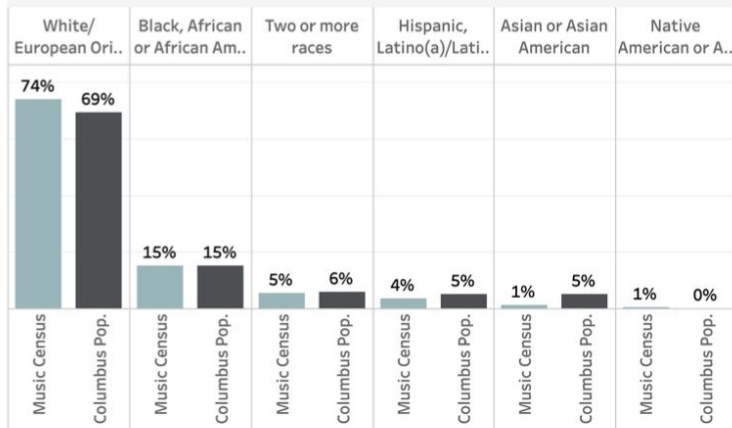
November 6 - December 15, 2023

8% venue/presenter

13% industry

79% music creatives

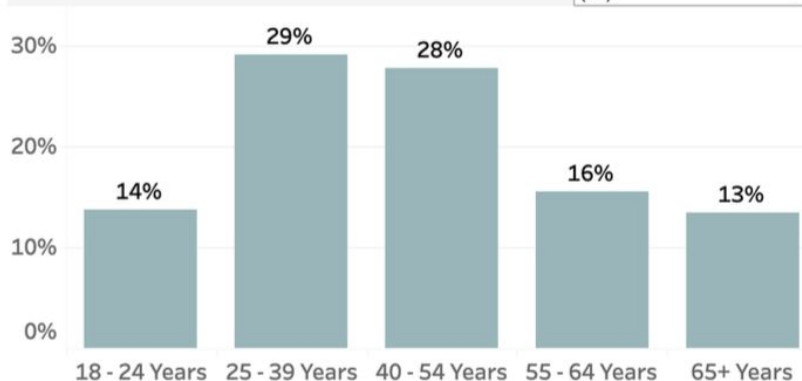
Race & Ethnicity



Age

Main Music Sector

(All)

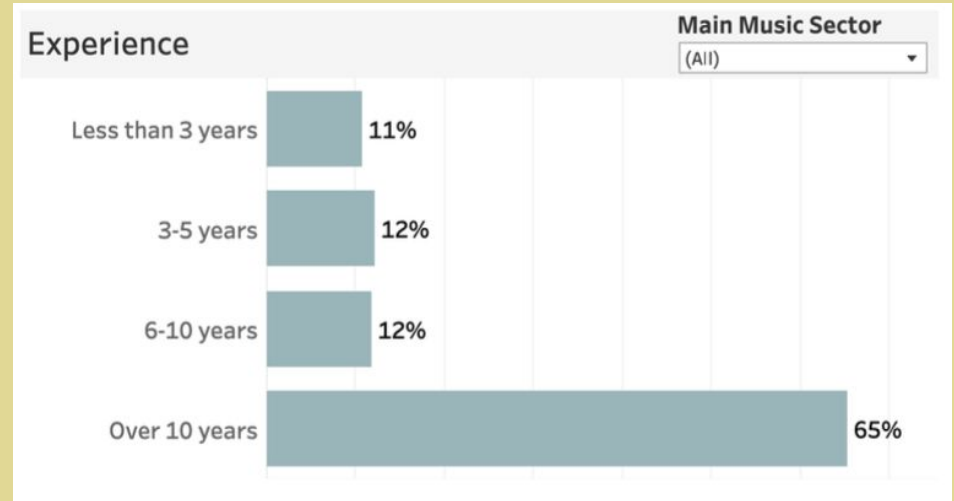


Key Insight 1: Robust Pipeline of New Entrants

Across all parts of the ecosystem

- Creatives - 10%
- Venue/Presenter - 11%
- Industry - 16%

Average new entrants in other cities = 8.3%

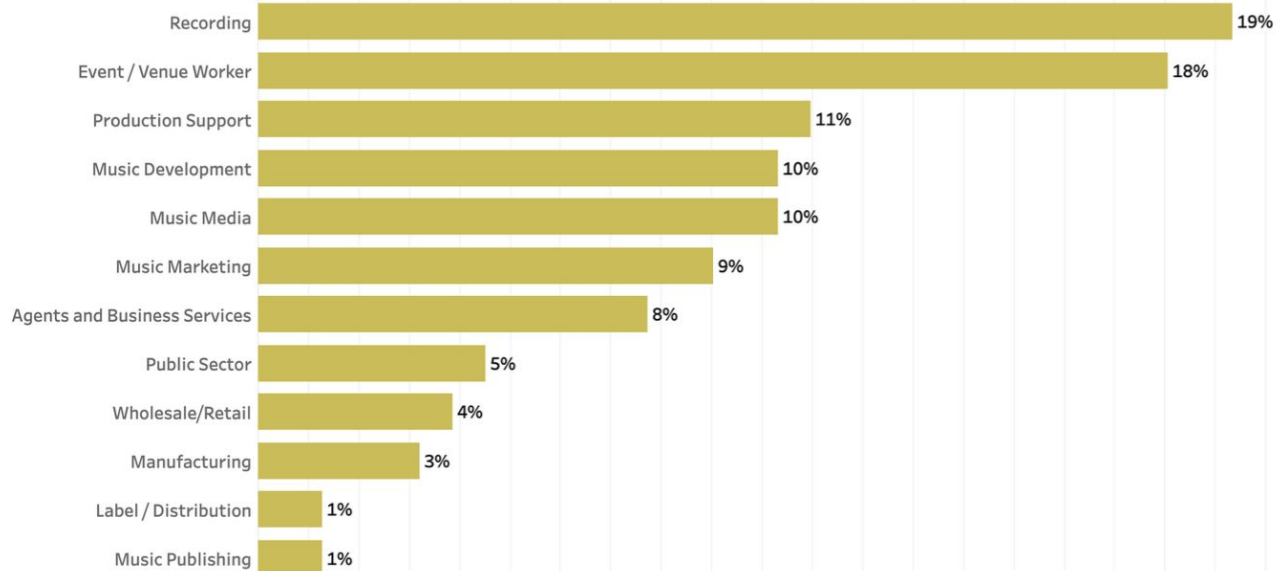


Creative, Venue, & Industry Profiles

- 66% of Creatives have **over 10 years experience**; 78% plan to continue for the next 3 years
- Of 124 Venue/Presenter respondents, majority are live music venues and total average live music events/year = 94
- Industry respondents represent mainly recording or event/venue work (37%) - **Only 5% work in manufacturing, label/distribution, and music publishing.**

Key Insight 2: Lack of Music Industry Infrastructure

Industry Current Occupation



**Industry
representation = 13%**

**Optimal
representation based
on other
cities/regions = 20%**

Economic Activity

Primarily a freelance, independent workforce.

- 68% of respondents work another job outside of music
 - 88% seek outside work for added income security: not enough earnings from music alone
 - 53% seek it for benefits (health insurance and retirement).

Average annual income
from music is
\$19,390/respondent

Across the 1,555
respondents, music
generates a total of
\$30M in income annually

Average household
income for respondents is
\$86, 225

22% of respondent annual
income comes from
music

Key Insight 3: Dependence on Local Gigs

Creatives rely heavily on local performances, which generally provide less than \$1,000/month income.

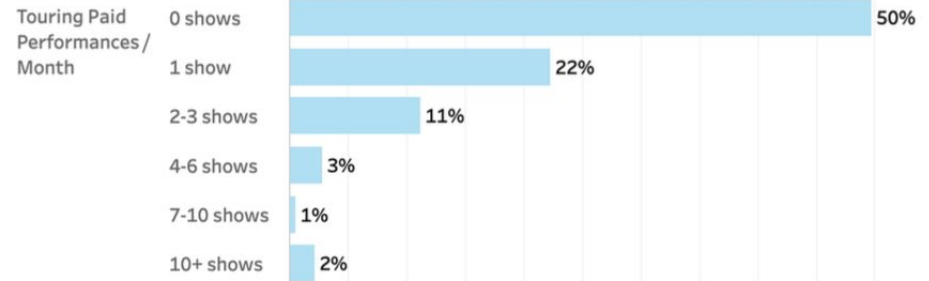
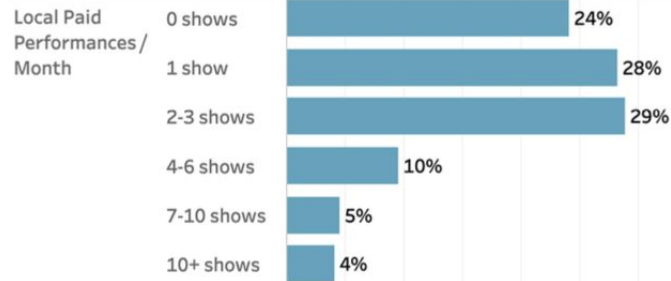
\$233

average pay/local gig

\$346

average pay/touring gig

Creative Paid Performances / Month



Ecosystem Development

62% of respondents report that their #1 local music resource preference is “A place to connect with music services (agency, record label, artist management, publicity, business, etc.) with the next two highest requested resources are a space to connect and collaborate musically and space to connect with other creatives.

89% of respondents report that securing workspace is too expensive

Key Insight 2: Lack of Music Industry Infrastructure

Music Hub is something people want and could fill several gaps in services.

“Wish there were more workshops and collaboration spaces.”

“We need options for rehearsal space.”

“I see a lack of affordable, safe rehearsal and performance spaces as the biggest issues all over the country.”

Workforce Development

Largely self-taught workforce: **58% trained by experience**, while 29% have or are completing a higher education degree in music or another field.

61% do NOT have any of the traditional registration memberships (such as The Recording Academy, royalty collection and music licensing orgs, professional trade organizations, unions, etc.) that can yield additional revenue

Key Insight 4: Professional Development Needs

Our community could benefit from various levels of professional development to build more diverse income streams and improve their earnings potential.

- 50% - Continuing Ed/Specialized Ed
- 44% - Leadership Training
- 41% - Introductory Workshops

Guiding our community to maximize the potential of registration memberships as income streams should be included in this educational planning as well.

Livability

- Low or uncertain pay is the top “Music Career Challenge” for **90% of respondents**
- **Only 26% of respondents** said 100% of their gigs provided a payment Guarantee

Key Insight 5: Mismatch of Experience & Job Opportunities

Despite a lot of industry experience among locals (65% have 10+ years), there is a shortage of corresponding, well-compensated job opportunities in the music sector.

- *Only 27% of Creatives note a pay guarantee for every performance; 30% have never received a pay guarantee for performances*
- **Pay Guarantee is closer to 50% in other cities!**

Music Friendly Policy

No major policy barriers surfaced.

Sound/noise policy works - only 2% cite sound policy as an issue of greatest impact/challenge

Regulatory Challenges of medium or greater concern:

- Cost of Permits (67%)
- Confusion/Inefficiency (51%)
- Inspections (48%) & Special Event Specifics (48%)

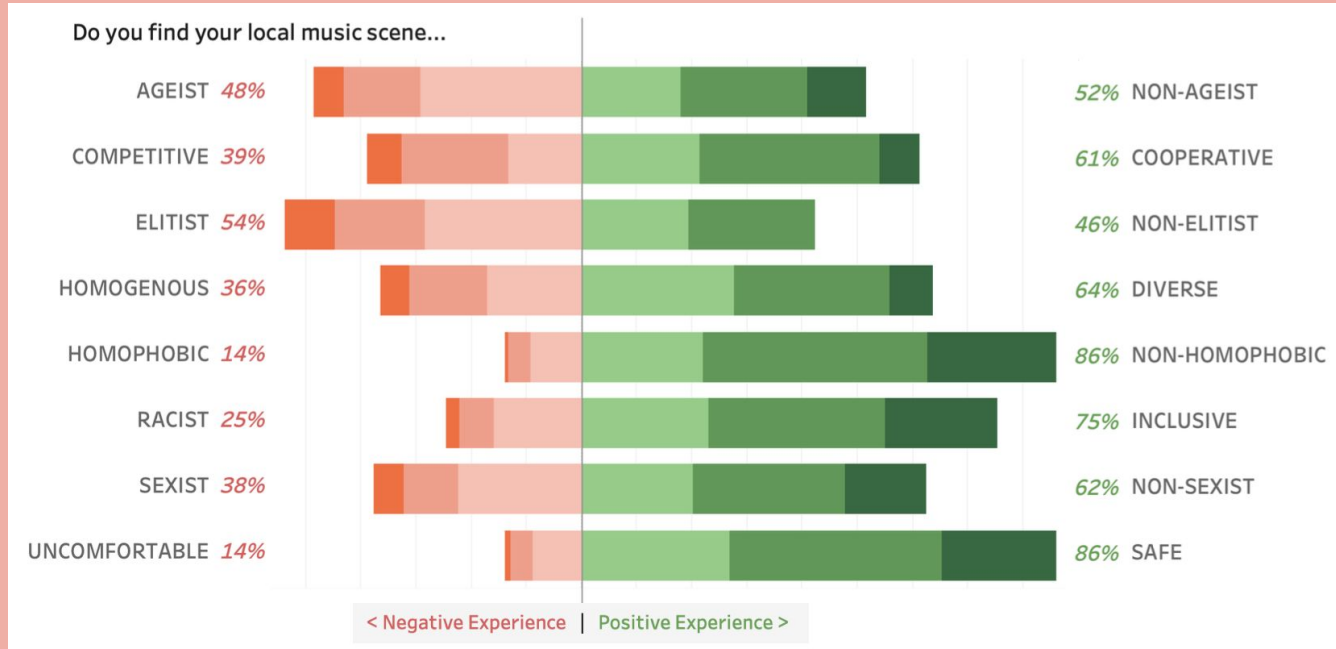
Key Insight 6: Financial Assistance Needs

#1 Regulatory Tool preference requested by Venue/Presenters:

- Tax discounts, waivers, incentives to host live music & Webpage of current regulations [specific to live music] (both 72%)

Overall, 76% of respondents have not received financial assistance for music work

Culture & Belonging



Key Insight 7: Liveable Environment for Musicians

Overall, the data indicates that Columbus appears to provide a **culturally rich and welcoming atmosphere for a majority of the music ecosystem**. There is a sense of belonging within a vibrant cultural scene that makes Columbus an attractive place for musicians and professionals alike.

However, comments reflect concern over the **perceived elitism and lack of support for niche and culturally specific music genres**.

OPPORTUNITIES

Enhance Music Business Education

Offer targeted educational programs that cover essential business skills, legal knowledge, and financial management, crucial for artist independence and career longevity.

Key Insight #1 & 4
Robust Pipeline of New
Entrants & Professional
Development Needs

Columbus Music Hub & Industry Infrastructure Development

Key Insight #2
Lack of Music Industry
Infrastructure



Export Music Columbus

Key Insight #3
Dependence on
Local Gigs



Set Fair Compensation Standards

Promote the establishment of industry standards and best practices for gig payments and fair employment practices of music creatives.

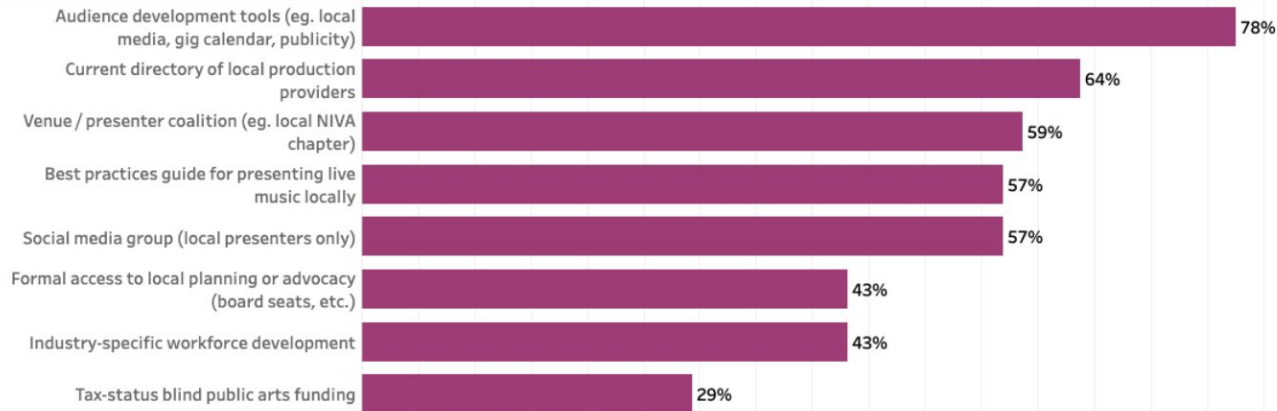
This includes the investigation and advocacy for policy-driven solutions that build off successful strategies in other cities.



Key Insight #5 & 6
Mismatch of Experience
& Job Opportunities And
Financial Assistance
Needs

Prioritize Marketing & Audience Building

Venue/Presenters Preference for Business Resources



Key Insight #5 Mismatch of Experience & Job Opportunities

“We need more marketing and PR resources.”

“A lack of marketing to the general public”

“Columbus needs audience cultivation.”

“Community/Consumer education and engagement - there is amazing talent in the city, and Columbus people love to support local... There is a huge disconnect between the community's appreciation for local music, and how often they actually get out to support it and become immersed in it.”

Music Genre Development

Key Insight #7
Livable Environment

Opportunity to initiate a music genre development initiative in Columbus to broaden performer and audience diversity at live music events.

Goals should include: enhancing artistic experiences, educational outreach, and targeted marketing

What do WE do now?

Fall 2024

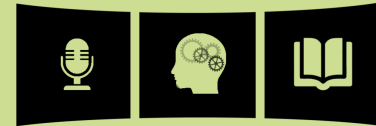
- Strategy Development kickoff
- In collaboration with leading consultants and our community

September 2024

- We will hold a series of Community Engagement Sessions with various music industry representatives, allies, and stakeholders
- Interested in hosting one? Email Us!

Thank you!

MUSIC**COLUMB**[★]**US**



LACHANDRA B. BAKER
EDUTAINMENT

MUSIC**COLUMB**[★]**US**



QUESTIONS?